further from the truth, as I come out of the shower wrapped in a towel asking him about whether he's been using my conditioner.

The 'sprinkler' is born, a dance move imitating a garden sprinkler. I feel like I do it on a night out, but Paul Collingwood will later take credit for its birth. We film all the team doing it, even including Pakistan legend and bowling coach Mushtaq Ahmed – Swanny says the three white stripes in his beard are sponsored by Adidas. Each player has their own version, most are awful, every one developing in each training practice until Jonathan Trott is sprinkling a constant flow of water from his mouth as he does it, making his a multi-dimensional experience. When we win the second Test by an innings, it begins to grow unbelievably popular – people across the country are sending in videos of themselves doing it.

This win also gives the feeling of something special happening that is carrying us all. There is a sudden belief that this could actually happen this time, an away Ashes win that an entire generation hasn't seen before. Alongside this, people at home are able to reach and interact with the team, given a little lens into our world to communicate with us. This mix of the painful with the effortless, the serious with the silly, is beginning to create momentum. It's the first time in my seven years in an England shirt that I can feel something magical is happening. It's like a tide of inevitability has embedded itself in the whole team through a collective will to win. Between the second and third Tests, I am allowed to fly home for the birth of my second daughter, Ruby. I am desperate to be there for it – something in my genetics is telling me to get back home as soon as I can.